

Title of Policy: “Policy for providing egov services and egov applications in local language(s)”

Preamble

Government of India (GoI) is implementing the Digital India programme as an umbrella programme to prepare India for a knowledge based transformation into a digitally empowered society and a knowledge economy. Under the overarching vision of Digital India, GoI aims to make Government services digitally accessible to citizens in their localities and to ensure efficiency, transparency and reliability of such services at affordable costs. To meet this objective there is a need to provide egov services and egov applications in local language(s) to be able to serve the general public. The benefits of egov services can reach the common man only when software tools and human machine interface systems are available in local language(s). Local languages in this context are constitutionally recognized Indian languages, currently viz. (1) Assamese, (2) Bengali, (3) Bodo, (4) Dogri, (5) Gujarati, (6) Hindi, (7) Kannada, (8) Kashmiri, (9) Konkani, (10) Malayalam, (11) Manipuri, (12) Maithili, (13) Marathi, (14) Nepali, (15) Oriya, (16) Punjabi, (17) Sanskrit, (18) Santhali, (19) Sindhi, (20) Tamil, (21) Telugu, (22) Urdu.

Lack of localization under the current framework may adversely affect the implementation of various MMPs (Mission Mode Project) and result in sub-optimal outcomes. Therefore, it is a compelling case for inclusion of localisation in the entire e-governance framework in the country to achieve full potential of e-governance in improving delivery of government services to citizens and other stakeholders.

Under e-Kranti (NeGP 2.0), Mission Mode Projects and other eGov initiatives focus on delivering services to citizens. It is imperative that the information and services provided to all the stakeholders through these applications are localized in Indian Languages. Localization should be made a priority for all e-Kranti (<http://deity.gov.in/content/e-kranti>) e-governance applications.

In view of the above, there is a need to formulate a policy for the Government Organizations to provide egov services and egov applications in local language(s) (hereinafter referred to as “Policy”) will give thrust to the formal adoption and use of local language(s) in egov applications development and provisioning of egov services in local language(s).

Vision

Making all egov services available to all citizens in their local language(s) to empower them.

Mission

In five years time mandating all egov service providers to adopt and implement this policy and citizens be able to avail the egov services in local language(s).

Objectives

- To provide a policy framework for offering egov services and egov applications with end-to-end local language(s) support.
- To empower the citizens by serving their needs in local language(s).
- To enhance the outreach of egov services and egov applications.

Definitions

Refer Glossary

Policy Statement

All egov services and egov applications should be compliant with NeGP (National e-governance programme) notified standards (<https://egovstandards.gov.in/>) and provide bilingual (English and Hindi) or trilingual (English, Hindi and Official language of state/Union Territory) or multilingual (English, Hindi and subset of constitutionally recognized Indian language(s)) egov services and egov applications.

Nature of Compliance

Mandatory

Applicability

The policy shall be applicable to all Central, State and Union Territory governments and associated egov service providers.

Exception

In certain specific domains where localization is not feasible, the concerned egov service provider can be exempted to adopt this policy with prior written approval of the concerned secretary/IT secretary.

Implementation Mechanism for Compliance

1. All government organizations, while implementing e-governance applications and services must include requirement of egov services and egov applications to be in local language(s) and egov notified standards compliance in their DPR (Detailed Project Report) / RFP (Request for Proposal)/ Tender.
2. The work orders issued by the government organizations should specifically include a clause for inclusion of egov services and egov applications to be in local language(s) and compliant with egov notified standards (<https://egovstandards.gov.in/>).
3. egov service providers shall submit a compliance report to this policy to the concerned govt. department/organization.
4. Concerned government organization / department in association with egov service providers shall establish suitable support mechanism for training, language technology development / re-engineering, etc.

Review of the Policy

GoI shall have the right to review the Policy as and when required.

Point of Contact

All queries or comments related to this policy shall be directed to JS (e-Governance), MeitY (jsegov@deity.gov.in).

Definitions

- 1 **Domain:** A sub-category under an Information Technology field is a Domain; specific purpose within a “Domain” is known as “Area”. For example, “Publishing of web content in Unicode is one area under the localization domain”.
- 2 **Systems:** A group of interacting, interrelated, or interdependent elements forming a complex whole. Information System is a combination of people, hardware, software, communication devices, network and data resources that processes (can be storing, retrieving, transforming information) data and information for a specific purpose.
- 3 **Local Language:** It refers to one of the constitutionally recognized Indian Languages.
- 4 **Localization:** Taking a product and making it linguistically and culturally appropriate to the target locale i.e. country/ region and language.
- 5 **Government Organization:** For the purpose of this policy, Government organization refers to all Ministries/ Departments/ offices/ statutory bodies/ autonomous bodies, both at the Central, State and Union Territory level.
- 6 **eGovernance:** A procedural approach in which the Government and the citizens, businesses, and other stakeholders are able to transact all or part of activities using Information and Communication Technology tools.
- 6 **egov services:** Any service or part thereof being provided to any person by the Central, State or Union Territory Government or public authority either directly or through any service provider and includes the receipt of forms and applications, issue or grant of any licence, permit, or certificate, sanction or approval and the receipt or payment of money, etc by whatever name called in a particular manner; [adopted from Ref draft EDS Bill document at <http://deity.gov.in/>]
- 7 **egov applications:** It is a software in the domain of governance.
- 8 **egov Service Provider :** It means any individual, agency, company, partnership firm, sole proprietor firm or any such other body or agency which has been authorized by the Central, State or Union Territory Government to offer services through electronic mode; [adopted from Ref draft EDS Bill at <http://deity.gov.in/>]